

to use as a down payment on our future home. We used the time we previously spent commuting and doing home maintenance to work on advancing our careers while also having more time for fun. We both increased our incomes, and my wife negotiated a work-from-home position. We used some of our newly found free time to develop a love of cooking, which gave us a triple benefit—a new shared activity that also trimmed our midsections and improved our bottom line.

With all the money we saved, we paid off our house in only seven years. Now, none of our money goes to rent or mortgage payments. We owe nothing to anyone, so none of our money goes to interest on loans. We don't need to earn much income to support our lifestyle. This means we have little need for life and disability insurance. Because we don't need much income, we also pay little income tax, as we'll discuss in the next chapter. We live a rich life for very little money.

When you first start your path to FI, it can be difficult to appreciate all the factors that enable you to save money, while simultaneously enabling a better lifestyle. And we've only explored the tip of the iceberg. The concepts addressed in this chapter allow you to become financially solvent and establish a positive savings rate. In